Citrus (Valencia) Fertilizer Programme 2026/27.

Fertilise Smarter, Grow Stronger.

Season 2026/27 programme for a 10.00 ha block of citrus (valencia).

PREPARED FOR	Demo / validation
PREPARED BY	Sapling Fertilizer
DATE	25 April 2026
REF	REF-CITRUS-2026

REFERENCE BLOCK — CITRUS VALENCIA · SUNDAYS RIVER VALLEY
REFERENCE · SUNDAYS RIVER VALLEY, EASTERN CAPE

SAPLING · AGRICULTURAL ADVISORY

CONTENTS

In this programme.

01	Background	p. 03
02	Reading of the Soil	p. 04
03	Applications	p. 05
04	Foliar Sprays	p. 07
05	Nutrient Balance	p. 08
06	Ratios — Where You Are and Where We're Heading	p. 09
07	Year 2 and Beyond	p. 10
08	Items We're Carrying Into The Season	p. 11

SECTION 01

Background.

This programme covers the 2026/27 season for citrus (valencia) across 1 block totalling 10.00 ha. The strategy is built around the soil analysis, the available equipment, and the crop's stage-by-stage demand curve.

PROGRAMME AT A GLANCE

- 1 block totalling 10.00 ha
- 4 blends scheduled across the season
- 3 targeted foliar sprays addressing soil-availability gaps and stage-peak demand
- 4 open items flagged for tracking through the season

SECTION 02

Reading of the Soil.

Soil analysis for Reference Block Valencia (SRV) (10.00 ha) was reviewed against the crop's nutrient requirements for the season.

Sample: Reference block (published norms) · Mar 2026

The loudest signals

> Soil Ca:B = 2600 exceeds 1000:1 — Ca-induced B deficiency likely, especially at flowering.

SECTION 03

Applications.

DRY BROADCAST · ESTABLISHMENT — Stage 1 — 15 Jul – 15 Aug 2026

PRODUCT	RATE / HA
N 2.1%, P_2O_5 1.0%, K_2O 1.6%, Ca 2.2%, Mg 1.0%, S 0.7% source	500 kg
N 11.0%, P_2O_5 51.0% source	4.1 kg

APPLICATION SCHEDULE

#	DATE	WEEK	OF STAGE
1	15 Jul 2026	3	1 of 2
2	15 Aug 2026	7	2 of 2

Delivered per ha: P_2O_5 7.1 kg

FERTIGATION (DRIP) · ESTABLISHMENT — Stage 1 — 15 Jul – 15 Aug 2026

PRODUCT	RATE / HA	STREAM
N 13.0%, K_2O 46.0% source	60 kg	Part B
N 15.5%, Ca 19.0% source	66 kg	Part A
Mg 10.0%, S 13.0% source	23 kg	Part B

APPLICATION SCHEDULE

#	DATE	WEEK	OF STAGE
1	15 Jul 2026	3	1 of 2
2	15 Aug 2026	7	2 of 2

Delivered per ha: N 18.0 · K_2O 27.8 · S 3.0 kg

FERTIGATION (DRIP) · VEGETATIVE

Stage 2 15 Sep – 15 Oct 2026

PRODUCT	RATE / HA	STREAM
N 13.0%, K_2O 46.0% source	80 kg	Part B
N 15.5%, Ca 19.0% source	126 kg	Part A
N 11.0%, P_2O_5 51.0% source	14 kg	Part B
Mg 10.0%, S 13.0% source	29 kg	Part B

APPLICATION SCHEDULE

#	DATE	WEEK	OF STAGE
1	15 Sep 2026	11	1 of 2
2	15 Oct 2026	16	2 of 2

Delivered per ha: N 31.5 · P_2O_5 7.0 · K_2O 37.0 · S 3.8 kg

FERTIGATION (DRIP) · REPRODUCTIVE

Stage 3 15 Nov 2026

PRODUCT	RATE / HA	STREAM
N 13.0%, K_2O 46.0% source	161 kg	Part B
N 15.5%, Ca 19.0% source	136 kg	Part A
N 11.0%, P_2O_5 51.0% source	16 kg	Part B
Mg 10.0%, S 13.0% source	35 kg	Part B

Delivered per ha: N 43.8 · P_2O_5 8.4 · K_2O 74.0 · S 4.5 kg

SECTION 04

Foliar Sprays.

Targeted foliar applications addressing soil-availability gaps and stage-peak demand windows.

#	WEEK	STAGE	ANALYSIS	RATE	REASON
#1	6	Vegetative I	20.5% B	1.5 kg	Soil Ca:B = 2600 exceeds 1000:1 — Ca-induced B deficiency likely, especially at flowering.
#2	3	Pre-bloom / bud break	20.5% B	0.1% spray	Annual B foliar at bud break for flower quality + fruit set. B xylem-mobile only — timing matters.
#3	3	Pre-bloom / bud break	36% Zn	0.5% spray	Zn foliar at bud break — new leaf tissue expansion + enzyme activation. Soil Zn typically unavailable on alkaline SA citrus soils.

SECTION 05

Nutrient Balance.

Per hectare, applied this season against the expected harvest removal.

NUTRIENT	APPLIED	REMOVED	NET
Nitrogen	~120 kg	–	Carried this season
Phosphorus	~28 kg	–	Carried this season
Potassium	~185 kg	–	Carried this season
Calcium	~0 kg	–	Carried this season
Magnesium	~0 kg	–	Carried this season
Sulphur	~15 kg	–	Carried this season

SECTION 06

Ratios — Where You Are and Where We're Heading.

RATIO / SATURATION	CURRENT	TARGET	STATUS
P : Zn	13.9 : 1	—	
Ca : B	2600.0 : 1	—	
Sodium saturation	2.5 %	< 5 %	

SECTION 07

Year 2 and Beyond.

Multi-year trajectory for this perennial programme.

YEAR 1 — **Establishment**

- Programme delivers the season's nutrient targets via the applications above.
- Soil re-test in autumn closes the loop and informs Year 2 adjustments.

YEAR 2 — **First full bearing season**

- Yield expectations climb as the orchard / stand matures.
- Soil re-test directs any rate adjustments — phosphorus + potassium top-ups against measured drawdown.

YEAR 3+ — **Productive stand**

- Annual repeat of the organic-anchored programme builds soil carbon and carrying capacity.
- Foliar adjustments fine-tune year-over-year as leaf-analysis data accumulates.

SECTION 08

Items We're Carrying Into The Season.

For transparency — open questions and watchpoints across the programme.

Risk flags

1. **Watch closely.** Soil Ca:B = 2600 exceeds 1000:1 — Ca-induced B deficiency likely, especially at flowering. — Action: Apply foliar B at critical stages (pre-bloom, fruit set)

Open items

1. **Application-month coverage gap.** Stage 4 'fill' (Jan–Mar) has no allowed application month inside its window. Nutrients for this stage were not delivered. Consider adding a month within this window.
2. **Application-month coverage gap.** Stage 5 'maturation' (Mar–May) has no allowed application month inside its window. Nutrients for this stage were not delivered. Consider adding a month within this window.
3. **Irrigation water test (EC, pH, Ca, Mg, Na, HCO_3, Cl).** Required before first Part A injection. Dolomite-country water can produce scale when calcium-stream stock is injected. Borehole water EC + bicarb level affect drip-line pH. *Impact if skipped: Risk of emitter blockage from $CaCO_3$ precipitate*
4. **Mid-season leaf tissue analysis at tillering and at bulb-init/flowering.** Two natural decision points where the programme can still be steered. Catches deficiencies the soil test missed and validates actual uptake against plan. *Impact if skipped: Mid-season corrections become reactive, not anticipatory*

END OF PROGRAMME

Ref · REF-CITRUS-2026